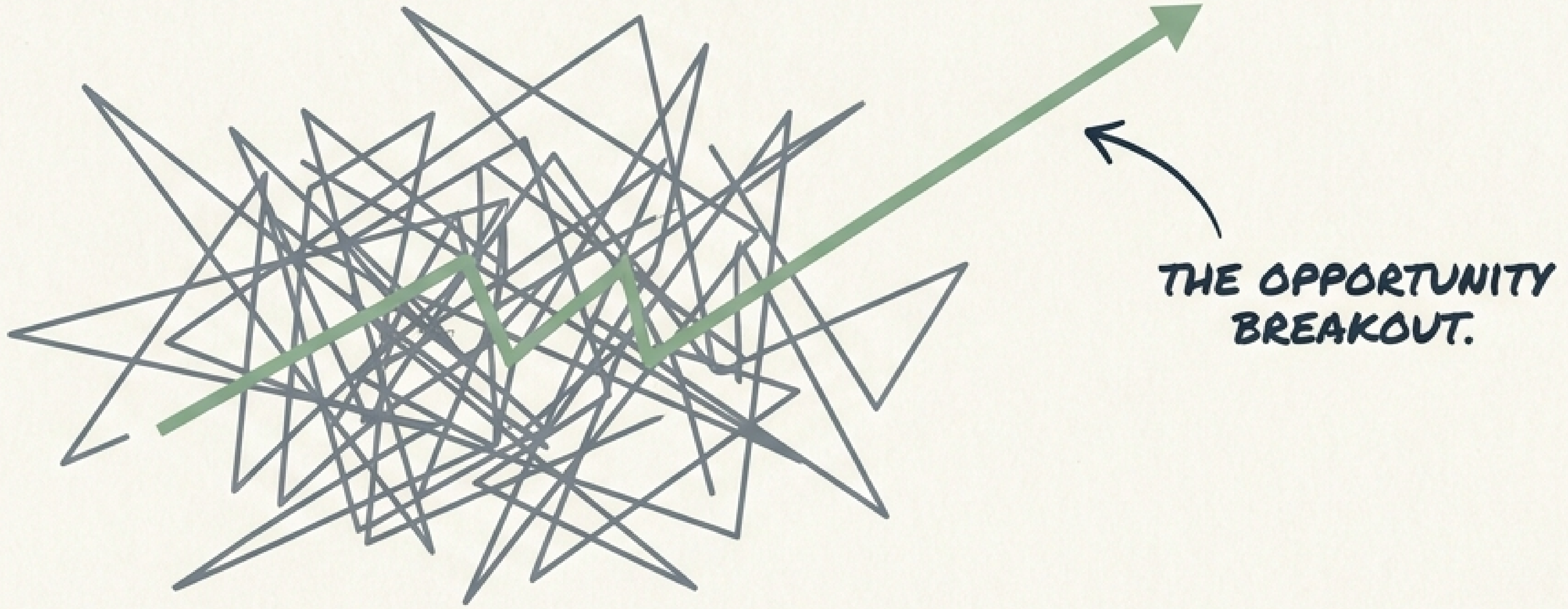
The Signal in the Noise

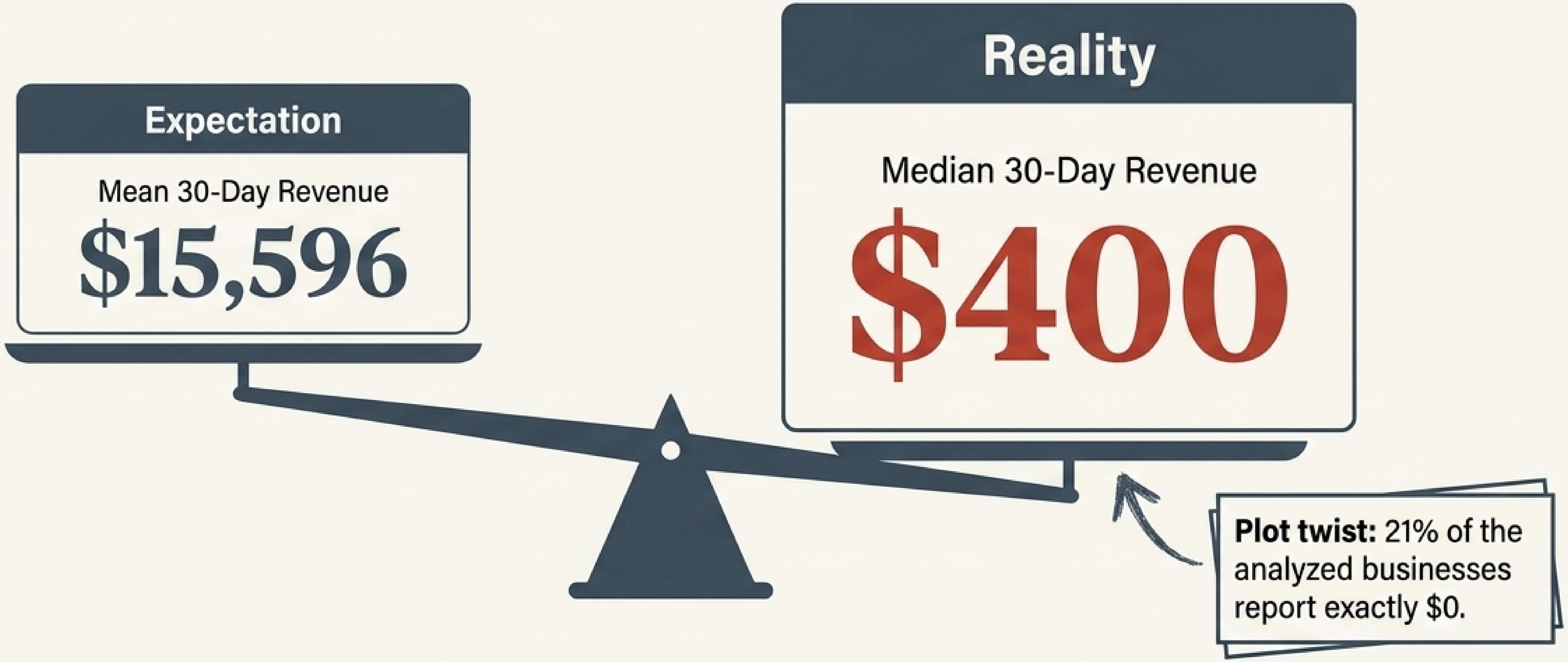
If I were starting an indie startup tomorrow, what should I avoid building, and where should I compete?



1,000 Startup Websites | $15.5M Total 30-Day Revenue | Dataset Frozen: July 2026

The typical indie business is much smaller than the internet implies.

Analyzing 1,000 active startups reveals a stark contrast between visible success and typical reality. The headline number is $15.5M in total monthly revenue, but the median reality is just enough to cover a car payment.



900 founders are fighting over 16% of the pie.

The indie startup market is highly concentrated. Outcomes depend heavily on whether a business enters the winner tail. Picking the wrong category guarantees a struggle, regardless of execution.

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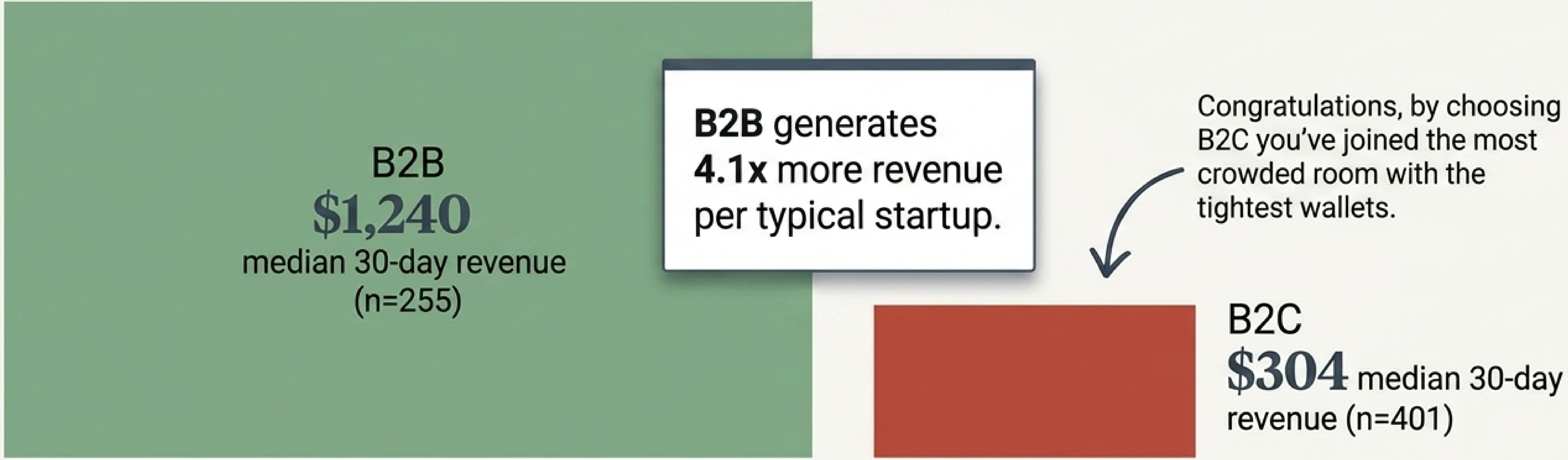
The leaderboard favors scale, repeat usage, and infrastructure.

High revenue appears across multiple categories, but the **visible outliers** share a common anatomy: they are the picks and shovels of the creator and B2B economies.

Stan	Supliful	Stack Influence
$2.84M / 30D Revenue	**$984.5K / 30D Revenue**	**$868.3K / 30D Revenue**
Category: Creator Platform	**Category:** B2B E-comm	**Category:** B2B Marketing
Metric: 101,590 active subs	**Metric:** Domain Rating 71	**Metric:** Domain Rating 70

Building for consumers is a hobby. Building for businesses is a livelihood.

The B2B segment monetizes radically more effectively, driven by higher contract values and a concentrated willingness to pay.



The AI hype is real. The AI revenue is aggressively average.

Category prevalence measures founder attention; median monetization measures **observed commercial quality**. They should not be conflated.

Founder Attention

197

(The number of AI startups in the dataset, making it the largest category by far)

Customer Wallets

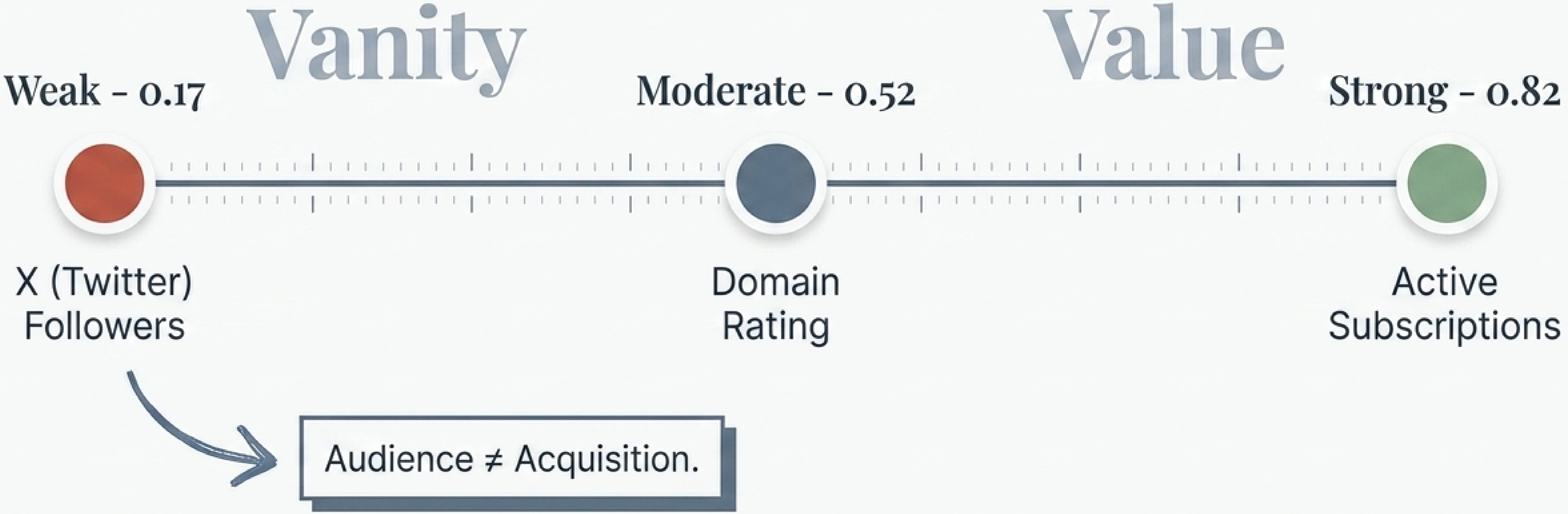
$503

(The median 30-day revenue for those AI startups)

Apparently, building another generic AI wrapper wasn't everyone's retirement plan.

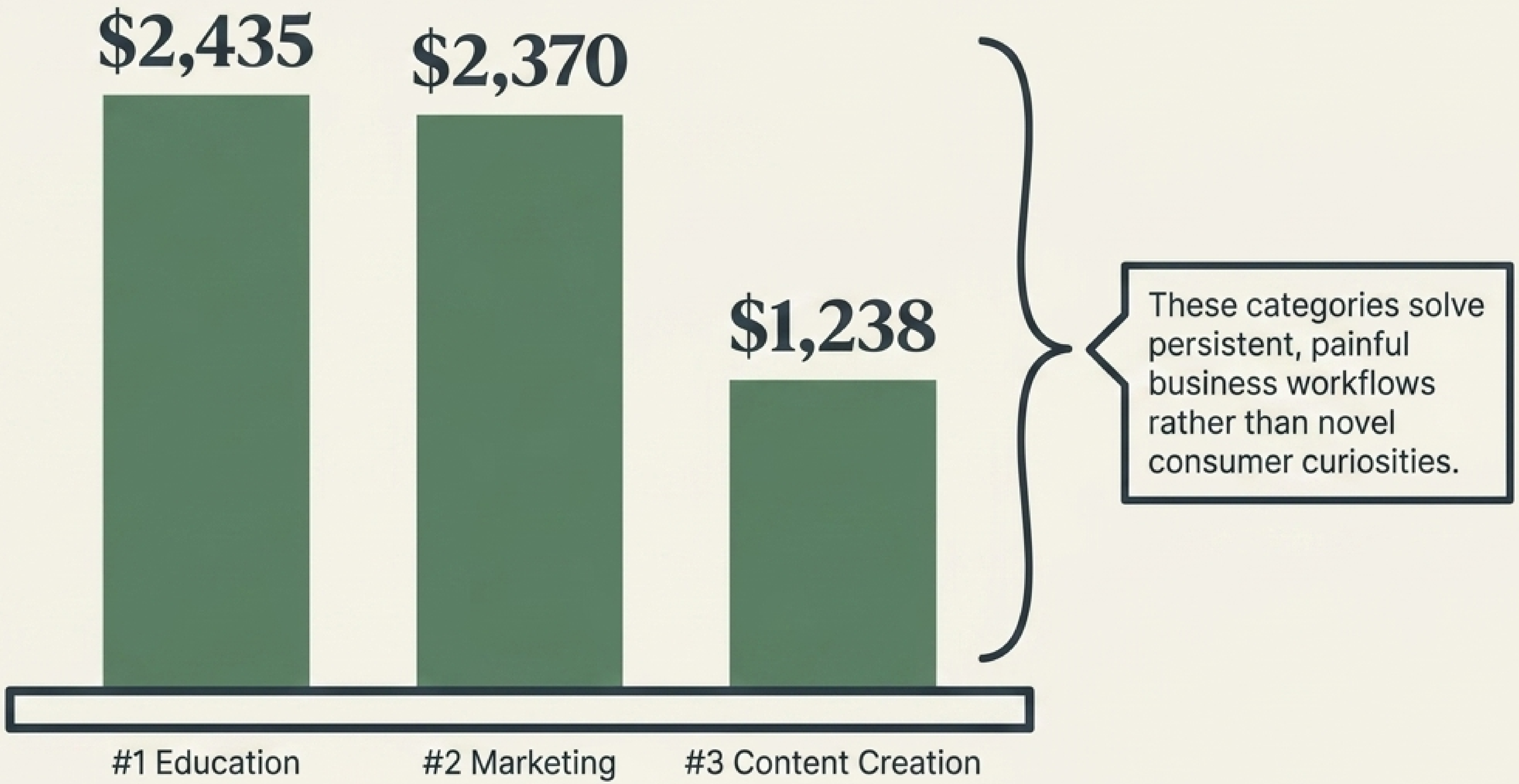
Twitter followers are great... unless you're trying to pay rent.

An analysis of revenue correlation proves that audience size on social media does not translate linearly to monthly recurring revenue.



Plot twist: the boring businesses are quietly hoarding the cash.

While founders flock to trendy categories, unsexy B2B workflow tools demonstrate significantly stronger median monetization.



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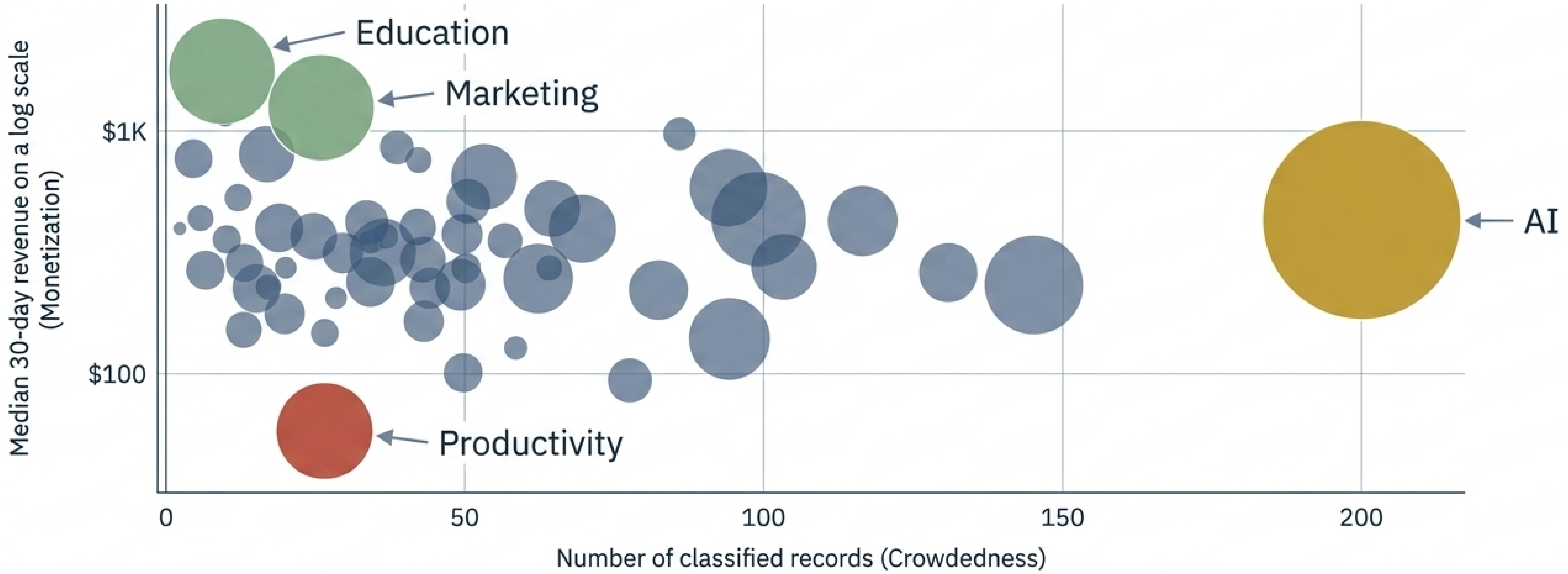
Category size and category monetization are fundamentally different questions.

A macro view of the startup landscape reveals where founders are currently misallocating their time.



The Red Zone: Categories with more founders than customers.

If you are launching in these categories tomorrow, you are fighting an uphill battle against fundamental market economics.

Focus 1: Productivity

49 startups analyzed.
Median revenue: $80.

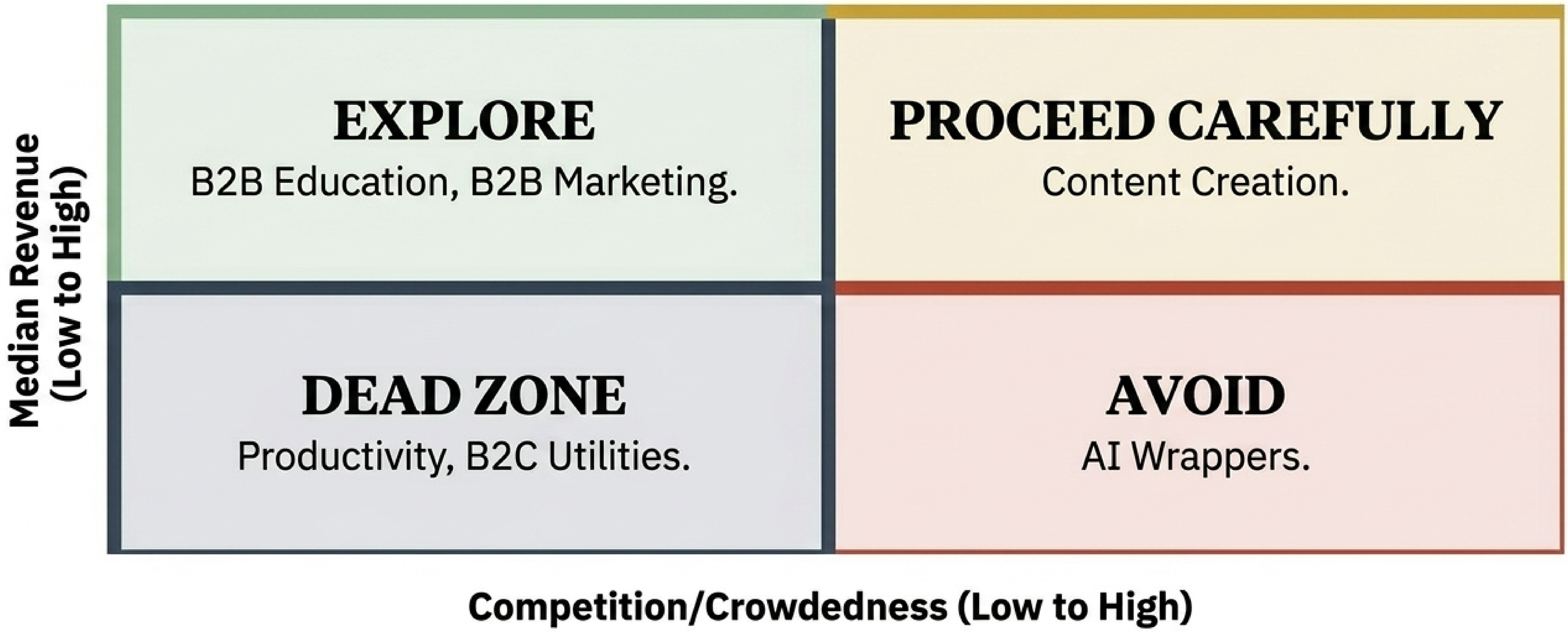
Building a habit tracker or a to-do list is a right of passage for developers, not a viable business model.

Focus 2:
Focus 2:
B2C General

401 startups analyzed.
401 startups analyzed.
Median revenue: $304.

The Founder Opportunity Matrix

Risk-adjusted opportunity mapped by market saturation vs. proven willingness to pay.



The Indie Hacker Decision Framework

Before writing a single line of code **tomorrow, filter your idea through the baseline realities of the market.**

1. **Is this a B2B problem where I can charge $1,000+ annually?**
2. **Am I entering a category with proven median revenue (e.g., Marketing, Education)?**
3. **Does acquisition rely on organic search/domain rating rather than just Twitter followers?**
4. **Am I solving a boring workflow rather than building a trendy AI wrapper?**
5. **Would I still build this knowing the median outcome is $400/month?**